

Call for Expressions of Interest

<i>Date of Issue:</i>	September 2026
<i>Expected Completion Date:</i>	May 2027
<i>Project Title:</i>	The App App
<i>Company:</i>	Please provide company name

Contact Details

<i>Lead Contact:</i>	Dr Alfie Cameron
<i>Lead E-mail:</i>	alfie.cameron@nottingham.ac.uk
<i>Additional Contact:</i>	Additional contact name
<i>E-mail:</i>	Additional contact e-mail
<i>Additional Contact:</i>	Additional contact name
<i>E-mail:</i>	Additional contact e-mail
<i>Additional Contact:</i>	Additional contact name
<i>E-mail:</i>	Additional contact e-mail

Additional Info

<i>Students must sign NDA:</i>	☐
<i>Project uses personal data:</i>	☐
<i>Custom hardware required:</i>	☐ If Applicable: Please provide details
<i>Relevant research areas (if applicable)¹:</i>	App design, education, gamification

Project Background Information

Background: Computer Science is a fascinating subject that is highly influential in most every sector. From Geography, to medicine, to economics and beyond, information systems and automation are fundamental to much of the modern world. Despite this, learning how to design and build simple technologies we use in everyday life requires substantial investment of time, energy, money, and other precious resources, creating barriers to entry that slow innovation and learning. There are a huge range of existing resources online that openly share educational materials but finding reliable sources requires an existing level of knowledge, and the materials often reflect that assumption, which can be overwhelming, de-motivating, and frustrating for people starting from scratch. Aims: Your team will develop an educational app or webapp that teaches users how to start building their own app. The app should not attempt to teach every possible thing the user might need to know. Instead, it should equip the user with enough knowledge and confidence to start developing and to be able to independently pursue their own research when needed. The student team must decide what information to prioritise for these purposes. This also applies
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¹ An overview of different research areas in the school of computer science can be found [here](#).

to recommending specific resources – teams must decide when it is appropriate to recommend specific resources versus when they should equip the user to find their own.

Information in the app should use clear, simple language, and should be provided in a linear order according to the development process. Teams can choose to deliver information in whatever way they think is most appropriate, but they must include some way to periodically measure progress and allow users to revisit past topics. They may choose to do this, for example, in a course structure with clearly delineated lessons and assessment points, or as a gamified experience with interactive elements. The team must be able to justify their choice for how the content is delivered.

Objectives:

- Identify different kinds of learning and teaching methods that can be used in designing The App App.
- Decide what content to include in the app and when to signpost to external resources.
- Develop an app or web app that will help users learn to develop their own app.
- Provide clear, step-by-step guidance in the app that spans the full lifecycle of development, e.g.:
 - Identifying what problem the app addresses
 - The benefits and limitations of native apps versus progressive web apps
 - The difference between frontend and backend
 - Choosing the right IDE, coding tools, languages, etc.
 - Post-development testing and publishing.
- Embed modes of evaluation or assessment to test user learning.

Requirements

The group must provide:

- A functional app or web app that teaches principles of app development
- Clear, simple, accessible language
- Assessment/evaluation points for users to measure progress
- A way for users to revisit previous content

Skills	
<i>Highly desirable:</i> App development Frontend dev skills Backend dev skills	<i>Desirable:</i> UX Design UI Design
Submission / Award information	
<i>Date of Submission:</i>	September 2026
<i>Date of Pitch:</i>	October 2026
<i>Notification of award:</i>	October 2026

For further information on this proposal, the team representative should in the first instance e-mail the lead contact stated above at the e-mail address provided.